

DevTrails CTF 2026

INCIDENT BRIEFING — CLASSIFIED

None

FROM: DevTrails Security Operations Center
TO: CTF Operatives
RE: Compromised Container – Immediate Investigation Required
STATUS: ACTIVE

Our monitoring systems flagged anomalous activity on a **GhostLabs Inc.** development server. It appears someone pushed an internal dev container straight to production — **without any cleanup.**

Environment variables are leaking. Config files hold secrets in plain sight. Log files remember everything. The sysadmin who deployed it? **Gone.** Left in a hurry. No handoff. No notes.

We need you to get inside that container and find out exactly what was left behind.

There are 5 pieces of sensitive data (flags) hidden inside. Find them all.

YOUR MISSION

None

OBJECTIVE: Locate all 5 flags inside the container

SUBMISSION FORMAT: DEVTRAILS{...}

DIFFICULTY: Easy → Hard

TIME LIMIT: 90 minute

FLAGS

Flag	Difficulty	Intel
Easy 1	Easy	Not everything is visible at first glance.
Easy 2	Easy	The container inherited secrets it shouldn't have.
Medium 1	Medium	A config value is "secured" — but the lock is decorative.
Boss 1	Boss	The system has a very good memory.
Hard 1	Hard	Someone left personal belongings behind.

DEPLOYMENT INSTRUCTIONS

You need Docker. If you don't have it: <https://docs.docker.com/get-docker/>

1. Pull the compromised container

None

```
docker pull  
ghcr.io/guidewiredevtrails/ghost-in-the-machine:sha-ae43b03
```

2. Spin it up

None

```
docker run -it -p 8080:8080  
ghcr.io/guidewiredevtrails/ghost-in-the-machine:sha-ae43b03
```

3. Access the web interface

Open your browser and go to:

None

```
http://localhost:8080
```

Read everything. Click every link. The server is talkative — it drops clues if you know where to look.

4. Get inside the container

Open a **second terminal** and drop into a shell:

```
None  
docker exec -it $(docker ps -q --filter  
ancestor=ghcr.io/guidewiredevtrails/ghost-in-the-machine:sha-ae43  
b03) /bin/bash
```

You're in. Start digging.

FLAG VERIFICATION & SUBMISSION

This is a **two-step process**. Pay attention — messing this up costs you time, and time is points.

STEP 1 — VERIFY: Go to <http://localhost:8080/verifyflag> and enter the flag you found. The system checks it against a hash — no guessing, no partial credit.

STEP 2 — SUBMIT: If the flag is correct, a **Google Form link appears**. Click it and submit. The form link **ONLY** appears on a successful verification. No shortcut.

SUBMISSION RULES — READ THIS CAREFULLY

- Use the **team leader email** for every flag submission.
- Use the **exact same team name** for every flag submission.
- **One submission per flag per team**. Duplicates will be discarded.
- Inconsistent names or emails = your submission will not count.

SCORING — FASTEST FINGERS FIRST

FLAGS HAVE DECAY POINTS. The first team to submit a flag gets **maximum points**. Every team that submits after? Gets fewer. The clock started when you read this.